

SUNDAY-SCHOOL ACTIVITY PACK

Jonah's Big Adventure

A Sunday-School Lesson on Obedience & Second Chances

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FOR AGES 4-12

Learning to obey God and that God gives second chances.

A complete lesson pack for teachers and families — story, memory verse, discussion, games, crafts and activities. Memory verse based on the International Children's Bible (ICB).

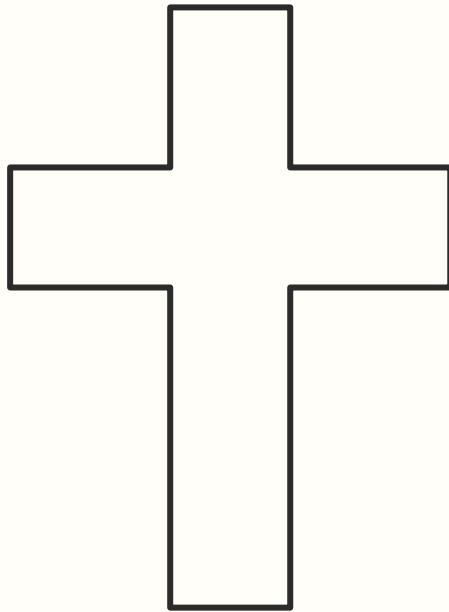
Welcome, Teacher!

Welcome to this lesson about Jonah and the big fish. This pack has a full session: story, memory verse, discussion, games, a craft and printable activities for ages 4 to 12.

How to Use This Pack

- Open with prayer and the icebreaker.
- Read the Bible Story (pages 6–9).
- Learn and discuss the memory verse.
- Choose activities, a game and the craft.
- Close in prayer and give out the certificate.

Teacher tip: A blue sheet or fabric makes a great 'sea' for the story and games.



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Lesson Aim & Teacher Preparation

Lesson aim: Children will learn to obey God and that God lovingly gives second chances.

Learning objectives

- Retell Jonah's adventure.
- Explain why obeying God is best.
- Recite the memory verse (Jonah 2:2).
- Name someone they can forgive or a fresh start they can make.

You will need

- Bibles or printed story pages
- Crayons, scissors, glue
- Paper plate for the fish craft
- Optional: a blue sheet for the 'sea'

Teacher tip: Practise the 'storm' sounds (clapping, stamping) so children can join in the story.

Opening Prayer & Gathering

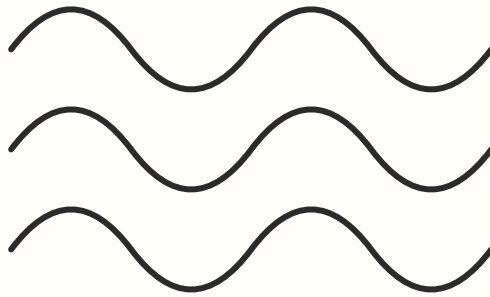
Welcome circle

Gather in a circle. Ask about a time someone gave them another chance and how it felt.

*Dear God, thank you that you always hear us and give us second chances.
Help us to obey you. Amen.*

Icebreaker question

Have you ever tried to run away from doing something? What happened?



The Bible Story — Part 1

Jonah Runs Away

God told Jonah, 'Go to the big city of Nineveh and tell the people to stop doing wrong.' But Jonah did not want to go.

Instead, Jonah got on a ship going the opposite way, trying to run away from God.

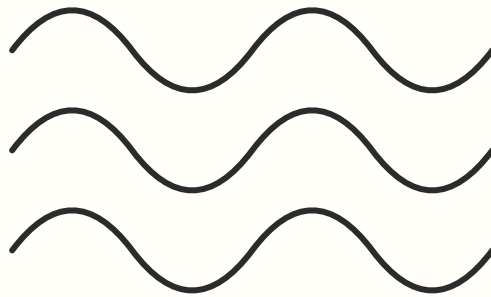


The Bible Story — Part 2

The Big Storm

God sent a huge storm. The wind roared and the waves crashed. The sailors were terrified.

Jonah knew it was because he had run away. He said, 'Throw me into the sea, and it will grow calm.'



The Bible Story — Part 3

Inside the Big Fish

When they threw Jonah in, the storm stopped. Then God sent a great big fish that swallowed Jonah whole.

Jonah was safe inside for three days. There, he prayed and told God he was sorry.

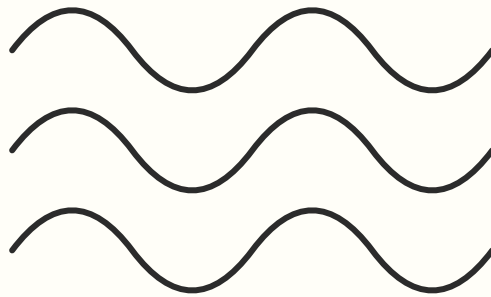


The Bible Story — Part 4

A Second Chance

God heard Jonah and had the fish bring him safely to dry land. 'Go to Nineveh,' God said again.

This time Jonah obeyed. The people of Nineveh listened and turned to God, who kindly forgave them.



Memory Verse

"I called to the Lord in my trouble, and he answered me."

Jonah 2:2 (ICB)

Read the verse together three times. Then trace it and say it from memory!

I called to the Lord in my trouble, and he
answered me.

Teacher tip: Have children cup hands like a fish while saying the verse to picture Jonah praying inside.



Talk About It

Discussion questions for the group

Sit in a circle. Let everyone share. There are no wrong answers when we talk about God's Word!

1. Why did Jonah try to run from God?

2. What did Jonah do inside the fish?

3. What does a 'second chance' mean?

4. Why is it good to obey God the first time?

5. Who can you forgive or be kind to this week?

What Did You Learn?

AGES 4-7

Circle the right answer

1. Where did God tell Jonah to go?

- a) Egypt b) **Nineveh** c) Rome

2. What swallowed Jonah?

- a) A wave b) **A big fish** c) A boat

3. How many days was Jonah inside?

- a) One b) **Three** c) Seven

4. God gave Jonah a second ____.

- a) fish b) **chance** c) storm



Think & Write

AGES 8-12

Answer in full sentences

1. Why did Jonah try to run away from God?

2. What did Jonah learn inside the fish?

3. Describe a time you were given a second chance.

4. How can you obey God even when it's hard?

True or False?

Statement	True	False
God told Jonah to go to Nineveh.	☐	☐
Jonah obeyed right away.	☐	☐
A big fish swallowed Jonah.	☐	☐
Jonah prayed inside the fish.	☐	☐
Nineveh ignored God's message.	☐	☐

Answers: T • F • T • T • F

Put the story in order (1-4)



God tells Jonah to go to Nineveh.



Jonah runs away and a storm comes.



A big fish swallows Jonah, and he prays.



Jonah obeys and Nineveh turns to God.

Word Search

AGES 8-12

Find the hidden words

O	T	Y	P	R	A	Y	V	N	X	X	H
N	I	N	E	V	E	H	Y	E	Q	P	F
G	T	O	A	E	B	Q	W	T	H	P	K
W	N	J	O	N	A	H	H	D	H	G	G
T	I	Y	E	G	I	T	Q	N	W	J	O
O	B	E	Y	F	N	Z	Y	M	Y	F	X
Q	P	M	A	B	L	W	R	H	G	D	W
P	S	T	O	R	M	N	D	W	V	N	O
H	P	G	F	K	K	B	Z	B	S	H	H
S	X	P	F	I	S	H	O	O	E	C	Q
C	I	A	Y	L	E	K	Q	R	A	J	Y
M	X	S	H	I	P	S	T	F	H	E	D

JONAH

FISH

STORM

SHIP

PRAY

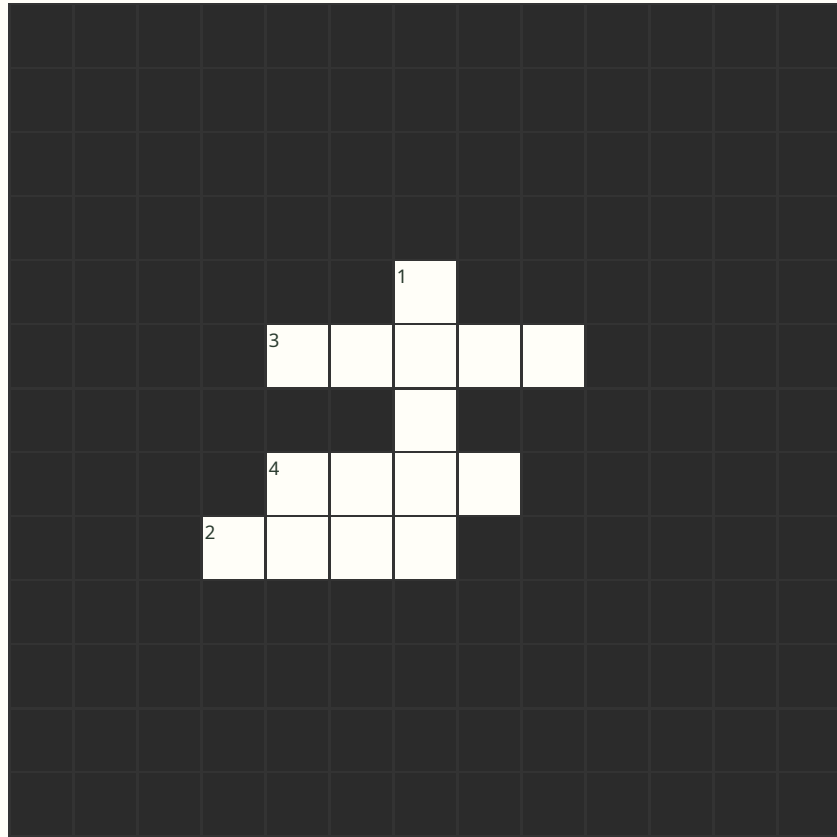
NINEVEH

SEA

OBEY

Crossword

Use the clues to fill the grid



Down

1. He ran from God, then obeyed.

Across

2. It swallowed Jonah.

3. Wild wind and waves at sea.

4. Jonah did this inside the fish.

Answers: 1 JONAH · 2 FISH · 3 STORM · 4 PRAY

Match the Pairs

Draw a line to match each word with its meaning

Match each word on the left to the right idea on the right.

- | | |
|-----------|-----------------------|
| Fish • | • give a fresh start |
| Ship • | • do what God says |
| Storm • | • talk to God |
| Pray • | • wild wind and waves |
| Obey • | • a boat on the sea |
| Forgive • | • swallowed Jonah |

Answers: Fish=swallowed Jonah • Ship=a boat on the sea • Storm=wild wind and waves • Pray=talk to God • Obey=do what God says • Forgive=give a fresh start

Fill in the Blanks

Use the word bank

Nineveh

ship

fish

prayed

chance

God told Jonah to go to _____.

Jonah ran away on a _____.

A big _____ swallowed Jonah.

Inside, Jonah _____ to God.

God gave Jonah a second _____.

Answers: Nineveh · ship · fish · prayed · chance

J-O-N-A-H Acrostic

Write a word or idea for each letter

For each letter of JONAH, write a word that reminds you of today's lesson.

J _____

O _____

N _____

A _____

H _____

Crack the Secret Code

AGES 8-12

Use the key to reveal the message

Each number stands for a letter. Write the letters to read the message!

1=A

2=B

4=D

5=E

7=G

8=H

15=0

18=R

19=S

21=U

25=Y

15 2 5 25

7 15 4 8 5 1 18 19 21 19

Answers: line 1 = **OBEY** · line 2 = **GOD HEARS US**

Colour the Big Fish

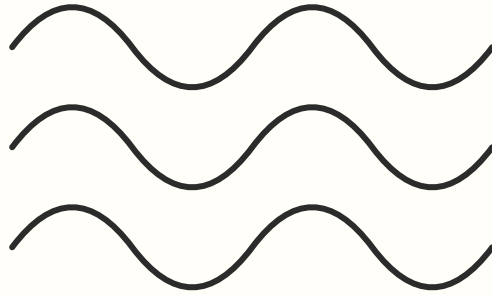
Sent by God



Give the fish big friendly eyes!

Colour the Stormy Sea

Big waves



Use dark blues and greys.

Colour Jonah Praying

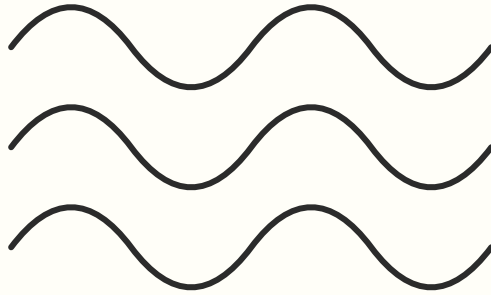
Inside the fish



Draw Jonah with folded hands.

Colour the City of Nineveh

They listened to God



Add happy people.

Count & Colour

AGES 4-7

Count the fish

Count each set, write the number in the box, and colour them in.



Spot the Difference

Find 5 differences

Look at the two pictures. Circle 5 things that are different in the second one.

Picture 1



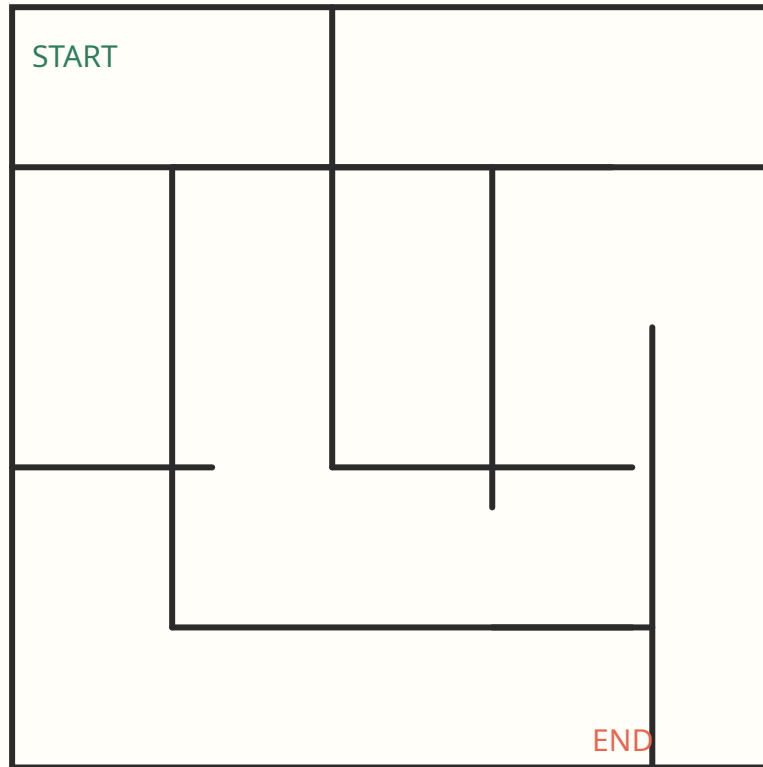
Picture 2



Help Jonah Reach Nineveh

Find the path through the maze

Guide Jonah from the shore to the city of Nineveh.

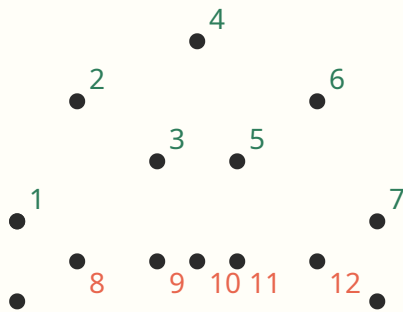


Dot to Dot

AGES 4-7

Join the dots 1 to 12

Connect the dots in order, then colour the picture you made.



Living It Out

Obeying God and forgiving like the lesson teaches

Read each situation. Circle the choice that pleases God. Talk about it together.

1. You are asked to do good but don't feel like it.

a) **Choose to obey anyway.** b) Run away from it.

2. You made a mistake and feel bad.

a) Hide and stay sad. b) **Say sorry and try again.**

3. Someone who was unkind says sorry.

a) **Forgive them kindly.** b) Stay angry.

Act It Out!

Retell the story with a simple drama

Teacher tip: Give children simple roles and props. Acting the story helps them remember it.

Roles & steps

1. Choose Jonah, sailors, and children to be the 'sea' and the 'big fish'.
2. Sailors 'rock' the boat during the storm.
3. The 'fish' (children in a circle) surrounds Jonah, who prays.
4. Jonah is set free and hurries off to Nineveh — the people cheer and turn to God!



Game: Storm & Calm

A fun game for the whole group

You need: space to move

How to play

1. When the leader says 'Storm!', children sway and make wind sounds.
2. When the leader says 'Calm!', everyone freezes still and quiet.
3. Anyone who moves during 'Calm' sits for a round.
4. Talk about how God calmed the real storm.

Teacher tip: Alternate quickly between storm and calm to keep everyone laughing and listening.

Craft: Paper-Plate Big Fish

Make Jonah's big fish!

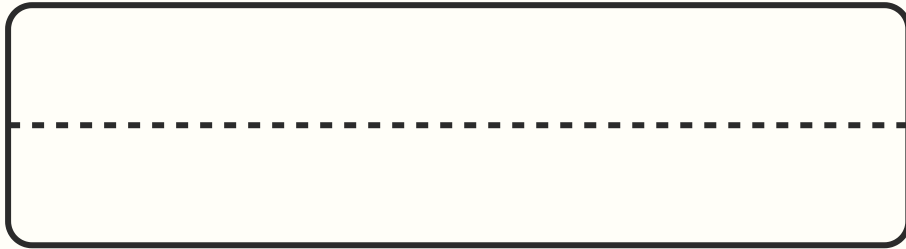
You need: a paper plate, crayons, scissors, glue

1. Cut a small triangle from the plate; glue it on the back as a tail.
2. Colour the fish and add scales.
3. Add a big eye and a friendly smile.
4. Remember: God can rescue us, just like he rescued Jonah!



Fish Template

Cut along the lines



Adult help with scissors, please!

Snack Idea & Memory Poster

Themed snack: Serve fish-shaped crackers and blue jelly 'sea' cups.



"I called to the Lord in my trouble, and he answered me."

JONAH 2:2

Take-Home Note for Families

Dear family, Today we learned about **Jonah's Big Adventure**. Jonah teaches us to obey God and that God lovingly gives second chances.

This week at home: Talk about obeying quickly, and forgive someone in the family this week.

Memory verse: "I called to the Lord in my trouble, and he answered me." — Jonah 2:2

A prayer to pray together at home

Dear God, thank you for second chances. Help our family to obey you and forgive one another. Amen.

My Favourite Part

Draw and write

Draw your favourite part of today's story:



Why did you like it?

This Week I Will...

Make a plan to live out the lesson

Write or draw one way you will live out today's lesson this week.

One thing I will do:

Someone I will show God's love to:

I will thank God for:

Let's Review!

Today we learned that Jonah ran away, but God rescued him and gave a second chance.
God hears us when we pray.

Obey God

Say Sorry

God Forgives



Great work today! Turn the page to pray and finish.

Closing Prayer

Pray together to finish the lesson

Dear God, thank you for always hearing us. Help us to obey you and to forgive others. Amen.

Now write your own short prayer to God.



Well Done!

You have finished Jonah's adventure! Obey God, say sorry when needed, and remember God forgives.



Turn the page for your special certificate!

Memory Verse Badge

Colour and wear it!



Cut out your badge and wear it with joy!



CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION

Jonah's Big Adventure

This certificate is proudly awarded to:

for learning to obey God and value second chances, just like Jonah!

Date

Teacher

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam